

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: East

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 9 3

♥ K 9 7

♦ A 3

♣ Q 10 4

♠ A 7

♥ A 8 3 2

♦ Q 6 2

♣ A K 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 5 4 2

♥ Q 10 5

♦ J 10 8

♣ 9 8 5

♠ K 6

♥ J 6 4

♦ K 9 7 5 4

♣ J 7 3

West

1 ♠

Pass

All Pass

3NT by North

North

1NT

3NT

East

Pass

South

2NT

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 5

When the going gets tough, the tough better figure out a good plan! Although you MIGHT manage to get an extra trick in ♥s or ♣s, you can see that your only real chance is to find a distribution that will give you 4 ♦ tricks. With that in mind, where do you win the first trick?

Without thinking it through you might decide to save that entry to dummy and win the first trick in your hand. But to get the 4 ♦ tricks you need you are going to have to make them play their ♦A WITHOUT using one of your two honors. That means the ♦A must be doubleton, AND you must lead through it. And WEST is the one most likely to hold ♦A x.

You win dummy's ♠K and play a low ♦. When West follows with the ♦3 you play your ♦Q which wins.

Then play a low ♦ from your hand, and **DUCK IN DUMMY**. West plays the ♦A on this trick and you are now home-free!

When you bid boldly you will get into a lot of contracts that are . . . challenging.

Sometimes you must try to visualize some possible distribution of the defender's cards which will allow you to make your bid and then just go ahead and play for that distribution.

A takeout double would not be a terrible bid. But if you don't overcall 1NT right now it will be hard to later convince partner that you have 17 points balanced. So you bite the bullet and say 1NT. Partner now bids 2NT.

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There is no point bidding ♥s; you are absolutely sure that partner does not have four of them. He has told you to bid 3NT with a maximum so you bid 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♠8. Of course East leads his partner's suit.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 5
♥ K Q 7
♦ K Q 7 3
♣ A J 9 6

♠ Q 10 6 4

♥ A 4

♦ A 10 2

♣ 8 4 3 2



♠ A K 7 3 2

♥ J 10 9 8 6

♦ 6 4

♣ 5

♠ J 8

♥ 5 3 2

♦ J 9 8 5

♣ K Q 10 7

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	2♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			

4♥ by East
first trick with the ♥A and returns the ♥4.

Loser List: ♠ = 2? : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 4?

You are surely going to lose the two red Aces, so you must keep the ♠ losers to 1. A possible Plan is to pull the last trump and trust the ♠s to split 3-3. Good Plan?

Stinking Plan. The chance of a 3-3 ♠ split is 36%, just a little over 1 in 3. A much better idea is to leave that trump out for a while longer, take your ♠ A K, and ruff one ♠ with dummy's last ♥. Then what?

Be careful, you are still in danger. You need to pull that last trump but playing ♣A and a ruff at this point could result in you losing trump control. First you need to establish a ♦ trick, so play the ♦K.

North wins the ♦A but he can't hurt you. Suppose he plays another ♦. You win in dummy, ruff a ♦ back to your hand, and pull South's last trump. Then play a ♠ to North's ♠Q. Your fifth ♠ is now established and you still have a trump to get to your hand with.

Suppose you ruffed a ♠ in dummy then returned to your hand by playing the ♣A, then ruffing a ♣.

You must then pull South's last trump, leaving you with only one trump.

When you give up the ♠ to North he could play a ♣, forcing you to use your last trump, and although you could take your ♠ winner you wouldn't have the ♦ trick established. Not an easy hand.

With two 5-card Major suits you can transfer to either one first. A good system is to use the "weaker" transfer to show an invitational hand, the "stronger" to show a forcing to game hand.

So you bid 2♥ and partner replies 2♠. What next?

With two 5-card Major suits you can transfer to either one first. A good system is to use the "weaker" transfer to show an invitational hand, the "stronger" to show a forcing to game hand.

So you bid 2♥ and partner replies 2♠. What next?

Partner now knows you have 5 ♠s, so you now bid 3♥ which lets him know you have 5 of that suit also. Partner chooses the ♥ game.

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♥2. North wins the